

VIJO JOHN

CFO-Track Finance Leader | Head of Finance | FP&A, Governance & AI Strategy

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Target: CFO / Finance Head mandates across Financial Services and AI-led Finance Transformation

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

CFO-track finance leader and hands-on AI transformation builder. 19+ years across BFSI, including early-career roles at Convergys and MetLife, with progressive ownership across accounting, controllership, financial reporting, taxation, FP&A, treasury, governance, fund administration, and post-M&A integration. Owns the full finance agenda and translates it into board-level insight, margin improvement, sustainable cost savings, and AI-enabled operating models for global Financial Services.

Experienced in complex financial reporting and statutory accounts under US GAAP and Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS), direct and indirect tax compliance, monthly and annual close, budgeting, forecasting, variance analysis, and board-facing CFO reporting packs. Proven track record delivering cost savings through vendor optimization, SaaS consolidation, offshore transition, automation, and process redesign while building and mentoring high-performing finance teams.

Differentiator: combines CFO-track finance leadership with practical Gen AI and Agentic AI execution. Designs and prototypes finance AI systems using LangGraph, RAG, evaluation harnesses, and governance controls across FP&A narratives, fund accounting, AP, O2C, R2R, reconciliations, reporting, taxation controls, and audit readiness. IIM Kozhikode MBA, Six Sigma Black Belt, former CISO, ISO 27001 / 9001 implementation experience, and six consecutive years of ITGC / SOC1 audits with zero material findings.

VALUE PROPOSITION, OBJECTIVE & DOMAIN EXPOSURE

Value Proposition	19+ years of experience with well-known conglomerates across Accounting & Financial Reporting, Taxation & Statutory Compliance, FP&A and Revenue Leadership, Fund Administration & Post-M&A Integration, People Leadership, and Board-Facing Strategic Impact.
Objective	Seeking a CFO / Finance Head mandate to lead the end-to-end finance function, including financial reporting, taxation, controllership, FP&A, treasury, board reporting, profitability, governance, and growth.
Domain Exposure	Capital Markets - Fund Administration, Banking, Insurance, IT.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Finance & Controllership	Accounting & Controllership Financial Reporting (US GAAP / Ind AS) Statutory Accounts & Audit Direct & Indirect Taxation FP&A, Budgeting, Forecasting & Variance P&L & Gross-Margin Management Cost Optimization & Savings Treasury & Cash Management Fund Accounting & NAV Internal Controls (ITGC / SOC1).
Leadership & Strategy	Board-Facing & C-Suite Reporting People Leadership & Team Scaling Strategic Transformation Post-M&A Integration GCC Operating Model Design Stakeholder & Client Management Governance & Regulatory Compliance Margin & Process Improvement Digital Finance & Automation.
AI & Product Strategy	AI use-case portfolio Build-vs-buy decisions CFO decision dashboards Agentic workflows RAG-grounded assistants LLM evaluation Human-in-the-loop controls AI governance Prototype-to-deployable delivery.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP IMPACT

- **Cost Savings:** Delivered ~USD 200,000 in annualized savings within six months through vendor optimization, SaaS consolidation, workforce training, offshore transition to India, and process automation.
- **Gross-Margin & Profitability:** Led P&L optimization and re-engineering initiatives that lifted productivity by 40% through workload assessment and process restructuring.
- **Board-Facing Reporting:** Designed CFO-level reporting packs, flash reports, financial models, and a streamlined performance reporting template that cut client-material preparation time by 80%.
- **Financial Reporting Enhancement:** Standardized the enterprise Chart of Accounts and accelerated month-end close from BD10 to BD8, improving multi-entity consolidation, MIS timelines by 2 days, and audit readiness.
- **Governance & Compliance:** Implemented governance policies that reduced compliance breaches by 40% and improved data-security protocols by 25%; appointed CISO, secured ISO 27001 certification, and established SOC readiness.
- **Audit Track Record:** Oversaw ITGC and SOC1 audits, maintaining six consecutive years with zero material findings while enhancing data security and control frameworks.
- **Client Onboarding & Migration:** Migrated 60+ clients to a new platform, achieving a 50% reduction in support tickets and improving client satisfaction and retention.
- **Entity Restructuring & Post-M&A:** Led incorporation of a new subsidiary as a direct arm of the US parent and managed cross-functional integration of acquired entities, simplifying the operating model for scalable cross-border operations.

AI STRATEGY IN FINANCE

Modern CFO Office	AI Finance OS FP&A narrative reporting CFO dashboards close automation reconciliation workflows MIS packs governance controls.
Technical Fluency	LangGraph Python FastAPI Streamlit PostgreSQL Qdrant Azure OpenAI Groq Llama Power Query ERP / accounting platforms.
Governance	Human-in-the-loop controls auditability data privacy by design ISO 27001 SOC1 model-risk awareness responsible AI adoption.

AI PRODUCTS, CONCEIVED, DESIGNED & DELIVERED

AI Finance OS

FLAGSHIP | Python | FastAPI | LangGraph | PostgreSQL | Streamlit
Autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph-orchestrated agents for bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, reconciliation workflows, and CFO decision dashboards.

FP&A Narrative Reporting Copilot

LATEST | Private repo | FP&A | narrative reporting | variance commentary
Private copilot converting financial performance data, variance drivers, and management-reporting context into executive-ready commentary for CFO reviews, MIS packs, board updates, and performance discussions.

NAV Break Investigation Agent

LangGraph | Azure OpenAI | Qdrant RAG
Detection to Investigation to Reflection agent loop grounded by RAG over NAV validation rules and investigation playbooks, with logging and an offline evaluation harness.

SOI Review Agent

8-agent pipeline | PDF extraction | ASC 946 RAG
Agent pipeline automating Schedule of Investments review under US GAAP ASC 946, including PDF extraction, SOI detection, validation, prior-cycle comparison, and preventive controls.

Enterprise Ethics Advisor

Multimodal RAG | CLIP | fully local
Fully local multimodal RAG for corporate ethics guidance with policy-diagram and text retrieval for governed AI advisory without external data exposure.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

McLaren Strategic Solutions, Vice President, Head of Finance | Jun 2025 - Present

- Lead the CFO-track finance agenda across accounting, controllership, financial reporting, taxation, FP&A, treasury, governance, controls, and board reporting across India and the US.
- Run finance end-to-end as design partner for AI products: AP, O2C, R2R, book closure, export invoicing, budgetary controls, earnout calculations, statutory compliance, and presales support.
- Design CFO-level dashboards, MIS packs, variance commentary, and performance reporting while translating finance priorities into agentic AI workflows for invoicing, reconciliation, reporting, and controls.
- Partner with senior leadership on AI strategy, governance, roadmap, profitability, risk, and audit readiness; bridge business stakeholders, engineering, finance operations, and auditors.

State Street, Bangalore, Sr. AVP / AVP / Sr. Manager, Financial Reporting | Jul 2018 - Jun 2025

- Progressive growth: Sr. Manager (2018), AVP (2020), Senior AVP (2023), Financial Reporting and Arc Reporting Product Owner.
- Owned requirements backlog and stakeholder priorities for the Arc financial-reporting platform, partnering with technology to drive reporting automation, data integrity, and on-time regulatory delivery.
- Built and led multi-tier reporting teams delivering US GAAP-compliant financial statements and reconciliations on schedule, improving client satisfaction and retention.
- Oversaw ITGC and SOC1 audits with zero material findings; accountable for reporting systems, data-feed integrity, internal controls, and governance relevance.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

HSBC EDPI, Gurgaon, Manager, Business Finance | Dec 2016 - Jul 2018

- Finance business partner for global operations, strategic insights, annual operating plans, budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis to guide business and operational decisions.
- Owned intercompany charging, recovery, and reconciliation; designed cost-recovery strategies and intercompany reporting across business units, ensuring accurate allocation and audit-ready reconciliations.
- Delivered executive reporting solutions, flash reports, standardized reporting packs, and CFO-level financial models for senior-leadership presentations.
- Engineered advanced data consolidation and reporting tools using Excel and Power Query, improving accuracy, consistency, and reporting timelines.

Ameriprise, Gurgaon, Trainer to Group Leader, Financial Reporting & Tax | Oct 2010 - Dec 2016

- Grew from Fund Accounting trainer to Group Leader across financial reporting and tax, building deep accounting, reconciliation, reporting, and people-leadership foundations.
- Led teams responsible for production delivery, quality control, knowledge transfer, KPI tracking, training, and operational governance.

Early Career, Convergys and MetLife | 2006 - 2010

- Built early-career grounding in operations, service delivery, training, quality discipline, team coordination, and process execution across global financial-services environments.

FINANCE DOMAIN DEPTH

Reporting & Controls	US GAAP, Ind AS, statutory accounts, audit readiness, ITGC / SOC1, internal controls, governance frameworks, data security protocols, ISO 27001, CISO experience.
FP&A & Board Insight	Budgeting, forecasting, variance analysis, CFO packs, flash reports, financial models, board-facing dashboards, margin analysis, performance reporting, and business recommendations.
Tax & Compliance	GST, TDS, India payroll, FEMA, MCA / ROC compliance, direct and indirect tax compliance, statutory filings, auditor and legal-advisor coordination.
Operations	Fund accounting, NAV, AP / P2P, O2C, AR, collections, DSO, R2R, month / quarter / annual close, intercompany accounting, reconciliation, billing, export invoicing, budgetary controls, and treasury / cash management.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA	Executive Post Graduate Programme, Strategy & Finance, Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Kozhikode, 2023.
Certifications	Six Sigma Black Belt ISO 27001 Implementer ISO 9001 Implementer Leader as a Coach.
Domains	Capital Markets and Fund Administration Banking Insurance IT US GAAP Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS).